[Resilience X]

Exit and Resignation Procedure

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1.0 Introduction

1.1 Our Philosophy on Employee Separations

At [Resilience X], we value the contributions of every employee. Whether your journey with us is long or short, we are committed to ensuring that your departure from the company is handled with professionalism, respect, and dignity[1]. We view the exit process not just as an administrative task, but as the final stage of the employee lifecycle—an opportunity to part on good terms, gather

valuable feedback, and maintain a positive, lasting relationship[2]. This policy is designed to provide a clear and structured framework that supports a smooth and respectful transition for all parties involved.

1.2 Purpose and Scope of This Policy

The purpose of this document is to outline the official procedures and expectations for all employees who are separating from [Resilience X][3]. It provides clear guidelines for the resignation process, the handover of responsibilities, the return of company assets, and the final settlement of pay and benefits. A standardized exit process ensures fairness, consistency, legal compliance, and the protection of company information and assets[4].

This policy applies to all regular full-time and part-time employees of the company, regardless of their position or tenure, for all types of employment separation[4].

1.3 Types of Employment Separation

Employment separation can occur in several ways. This policy primarily focuses on voluntary resignation but also provides an overview of other types of separation:

- Voluntary Resignation: When an employee chooses to end their employment with the company.
- Involuntary Termination: When the company ends the employment relationship. This may be for reasons such as performance issues, misconduct, or organizational restructuring (layoffs).
- Retirement: A voluntary separation initiated by an employee who meets the company's age and service criteria for retirement.
- End of Contract: The conclusion of a fixed-term employment contract.

1.4 Commitment to Confidentiality

All information related to an employee's separation will be treated as confidential and will only be shared with those who have a legitimate business need to know, such as the employee's manager, HR, and payroll staff[5]. We are committed to protecting the privacy of the departing employee while ensuring business continuity.

2.0 Voluntary Resignation

2.1 Providing Notice of Resignation

When you decide to leave the company, you are expected to provide sufficient notice to allow for a smooth transition of your responsibilities[6]. The standard notice periods are based on your role and are designed to provide adequate time for knowledge transfer and recruitment planning:

Employee Level	Minimum Notice Period
Non-Managerial and Individual Contributors	Two (2) weeks
Managerial (Supervisors, Managers)	Four (4) weeks

Employee Level	Minimum Notice Period
Executive-Level (Directors and above)	Six (6) weeks

Your individual employment agreement may specify a different notice period, which would take precedence.

Providing less than the required notice without mutual agreement may impact your eligibility for rehire and other post-employment considerations.

2.2 The Formal Resignation Letter

To initiate the process, you must submit a formal, written resignation letter[3].

- **Submission: The letter should be sent via email or delivered in person to your immediate supervisor, with a copy sent to your HR Business Partner.**
- **Content: The letter should be professional and concise. It must include:**
  - **A clear statement of your intent to resign.**
  - **Your intended last day of employment, based on the required notice period.**
  - **You may optionally include a brief, professional reason for your departure.**
  - **A brief expression of gratitude for the opportunity is always appreciated.**

2.3 Acknowledgment and Acceptance of Resignation

Once you have submitted your resignation letter, the following steps will take place:

1. **Your immediate supervisor will acknowledge receipt of your letter, typically within one (1) business day[3].**
2. **Your supervisor will then inform the HR department.**
3. **HR will send you a formal written confirmation of the company's acceptance of your resignation, confirming your last working day and outlining the next steps in the offboarding process. This confirmation will typically be sent within two (2) business days[3].**

2.4 Modifying the Notice Period

In certain circumstances, the notice period may be modified:

- **Shortening the Period: If you wish to leave earlier than your notice period requires, you may request this in writing. Approval is at the discretion of your manager and HR and depends on business needs.**
- **Payment in Lieu of Notice (PILON): The company reserves the right to ask you to leave immediately and pay you for your notice period instead. This is known as PILON.**
- **Garden Leave: The company may ask you not to attend the workplace during your notice period while remaining an employee. This is known as "garden leave."**
  Any changes to the notice period must be mutually agreed upon and documented in writing[3].

2.5 Rescinding a Resignation

If your circumstances change and you wish to withdraw your resignation after submitting it, you must discuss this with your manager and HR immediately. The company is under no obligation to accept a rescission, and a decision will be made based on business needs, such as whether a replacement has already been hired.

2.6 Case Example: Submitting a Professional Resignation

- **Scenario: Priya, a Senior Marketing Manager, has accepted a new role at another company. Her notice period is four weeks.**
- **Action:**
    1. **Priya schedules a private meeting with her manager, Tom, to inform him of her decision verbally.**
    2. **Immediately following the meeting, she emails her formal resignation letter to Tom and copies their HR Business Partner, Sarah. The letter states her last day will be in four weeks.**
    3. **Tom replies to her email within a few hours, acknowledging receipt and thanking her for her contributions.**
    4. **The next day, Sarah from HR emails Priya, formally accepting her resignation, confirming her last day, and attaching the offboarding checklist and information about the exit process.**

3.0 The Notice Period: Transition and Handover

The notice period is a critical time for ensuring business continuity. Your full cooperation and professionalism are expected until your last day of employment[4].

3.1 Employee Responsibilities During the Notice Period

- **Professionalism: Continue to perform your duties to the best of your ability and adhere to all company policies.**
- **Knowledge Transfer: Actively participate in the handover of your responsibilities. This includes organizing your files, documenting key processes, and providing training to colleagues or your replacement[2].**
- **Project Completion: Work with your manager to prioritize and complete any outstanding projects or tasks.**
- **Exit Formalities: Complete all required offboarding tasks in a timely manner.**

3.2 Manager Responsibilities

- **Develop a comprehensive transition plan for the departing employee's responsibilities.**
- **Communicate the departure to the team and key stakeholders appropriately.**
- **Facilitate the knowledge transfer process.**
- **Ensure the employee has the time and support to complete their exit formalities.**

- **Begin the recruitment process for a replacement, if applicable.**

3.3 Knowledge Transfer and Documentation

A thorough knowledge transfer is essential. Your manager will work with you to create a formal handover plan, which should include:

- **A list of all current projects, their status, and key contacts.**
- **Documentation of standard operating procedures (SOPs) for your core tasks.**
- **A list of important files and where they are located.**
- **Information on key internal and external relationships.**
- **A log of passwords for any accounts that need to be transferred (to be shared securely with your manager).**

3.4 Leave and Attendance During the Notice Period

- **Annual Leave/Vacation: Taking pre-planned vacation during the notice period is generally discouraged and is subject to manager approval. New leave requests during the notice period will typically not be approved.**
- **Sick Leave: The standard sick leave policy applies during the notice period.**
  The company reserves the right to extend the notice period to account for any leave taken.

3.5 Announcing the Departure

Your manager, in consultation with you and HR, will determine the appropriate timing and method for communicating your departure to the team and other stakeholders. It is important that the official announcement comes from your manager to ensure a clear and consistent message.

4.0 Offboarding: The Exit Process

The offboarding process is a structured set of steps to ensure a complete and formal separation[7].

4.1 The Offboarding Checklist

HR will provide you and your manager with an offboarding checklist to guide you through all the necessary steps. It is a shared responsibility between you, your manager, and HR to ensure all items on the checklist are completed before your last day[7].

4.2 The Exit Interview

The exit interview is a confidential, voluntary meeting between you and a member of the HR team[8].

- **Purpose: It is a valuable opportunity for the company to learn from your experience. We want to understand your reasons for leaving and gather honest feedback on our company culture, management, and work environment[1].**
- **Process: The interview is typically scheduled during your final week. It is a constructive conversation, not an interrogation. We encourage you to be open and candid.**

- **Anonymity: The feedback gathered is aggregated and used to identify trends and areas for improvement. Your individual comments will not be attributed to you in any reports shared with leadership unless you give explicit permission.**

4.3 Return of Company Property

You are required to return all company property in your possession on or before your last day of employment[5]. Failure to do so may result in a delay in your final payment or deductions for the value of the unreturned items. This includes, but is not limited to:

- **Laptop, monitor, and all computer peripherals**
- **Mobile phone or other mobile devices**
- **Company credit cards**
- **ID card and any access keys or fobs**
- **Company vehicle**
- **Any physical files, documents, or data**

4.4 Revocation of Access (IT and Physical)

On your last day of employment, the IT department will disable your access to all company systems, including email, internal networks, and software applications. Your building access card will also be deactivated[9].

4.5 The Clearance Process ("No-Dues")

During your final week, you will be required to complete a formal clearance process. This typically involves getting a sign-off (digital or physical) from various departments to confirm that you have settled all outstanding matters.

- **IT: Confirms return of all hardware and assets.**
- **Finance/Payroll: Confirms submission of all expense reports and return of credit cards.**
- **Library/Resource Center: Confirms return of any borrowed materials.**
- **Your Department: Confirms completion of knowledge transfer.**
  Your final payment processing is contingent upon the successful completion of this clearance.

4.6 Case Example: A Smooth Final Week

- **Scenario: It's David's last week with the company.**
- **Action:**
  1. **Monday: David's manager reviews the knowledge transfer document David has prepared and confirms it is complete.**
  2. **Tuesday: David meets with the Finance department to submit his final expense report.**
  3. **Wednesday: David has his exit interview with HR, where he provides constructive feedback.**

4. **Thursday: David works with the IT department to wipe his company phone and prepare his laptop for return.**
5. **Friday (Last Day): In the morning, David hands over his laptop, phone, and ID card to the IT helpdesk and gets his final clearance sign-off. He spends the rest of the morning saying goodbye to colleagues. His manager hosts a small farewell lunch for the team. At the end of the day, his systems access is revoked.**

5.0 Final Pay and Benefits

5.1 Calculation of the Final Paycheck

Your final paycheck will include:

- **Your regular earnings for the final pay period, up to your last day of employment.**
- **Payment for any accrued, unused vacation time, as required by state or local law[6].**
- **Any other bonuses, commissions, or payments that are due to you as of your separation date.**

5.2 Payout of Accrued Leave

The policy for paying out unused leave varies by location and leave type:

- **Vacation/Paid Time Off (PTO): Accrued, unused vacation time will be paid out in your final paycheck in accordance with applicable state and local laws.**
- **Sick Leave: Unused sick leave is generally not paid out upon separation.**
- **Compensatory Time: Any accrued compensatory time will be paid out[4].**

5.3 Expense Reimbursements

You must submit your final expense report for any outstanding business expenses before your last working day. Reimbursement for approved expenses will be included in your final payment or paid separately.

5.4 Benefits Continuation (COBRA)

If you are enrolled in the company's group health plans, you may be eligible to continue your medical, dental, and vision coverage for a limited time under the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA).

- **You will receive a COBRA election notice from our third-party administrator within 14 days of your last day of employment.**
- **If you elect COBRA, you will be responsible for paying the full premium plus a 2% administrative fee.**

5.5 Retirement Savings Plans (401k)

Your participation in the company's 401(k) plan will end on your separation date. You will receive information from our 401(k) provider outlining your options for your account balance, which may include:

- **Rolling it over to an IRA or your new employer's plan.**

- **Leaving the funds in our plan (if your balance meets the minimum threshold).**
- **Cashing out the balance (subject to taxes and penalties).**

5.6 Equity and Stock Plans

The treatment of any outstanding equity grants (e.g., stock options, RSUs) will be governed by the terms of your specific grant agreements and the company's stock plan documents. Please consult these documents or contact the stock administration team for details on vesting and exercise periods following your separation.

6.0 Involuntary Termination

6.1 Overview

Involuntary termination is when the company initiates the end of the employment relationship[4]. The process is managed by HR in conjunction with department leadership and is handled with sensitivity and respect.

6.2 The Termination Meeting

If your employment is being terminated, a termination meeting will be conducted by your manager and/or an HR representative. In this meeting, you will be informed of the reason for the decision, the effective date of termination, and any relevant information regarding final pay and benefits[5].

6.3 Severance Pay

In certain cases of involuntary termination (e.g., layoffs or restructuring), the company may offer a severance package. Eligibility for and the amount of any severance pay is at the company's discretion and may be contingent upon signing a separation agreement and release of claims.

7.0 Retirement

7.1 Planning for Retirement

We encourage employees who are considering retirement to speak with HR well in advance. HR can provide information on retirement plan options and retiree benefits to help you plan for this important life transition.

7.2 Notice and Transition

While the standard notice periods apply, we greatly appreciate longer notice from retiring employees to allow for robust succession planning and a well-deserved celebration of your career and contributions to the company.

7.3 Retiree Benefits

Depending on your years of service and other eligibility criteria, you may have access to certain retiree benefits. Please consult with HR for details on any available retiree health plans or other programs.

8.0 Post-Employment Information

8.1 Final Documents: Relieving Letter and Experience Certificate

Upon successful completion of all exit formalities, the HR department will issue you a formal relieving letter. This letter confirms your dates of employment, your last held job title, and that you have been relieved of your duties in good standing.

8.2 Employment References

To ensure consistency and protect your privacy, all requests for employment references must be directed to the HR department. The company's standard policy is to verify only your dates of employment and your last job title.

8.3 Re-Hiring Policy

Former employees who left the company in good standing and provided adequate notice may be considered for re-employment. Eligibility for rehire will be noted in your employee file. A break in service may impact seniority and benefits calculations upon re-hire.

8.4 Alumni Network

We encourage departing employees to join our official [Resilience X] Alumni Network on LinkedIn. It is a great way to stay connected with former colleagues and keep up with company news. We value the relationships we've built and consider our alumni an important part of our extended community.

9.0 Roles and Responsibilities Summary

Role	Key Responsibilities
Departing Employee	Provide written notice, complete knowledge transfer, fulfill duties during notice period, return all company property, complete exit formalities.
Manager	Acknowledge resignation, create a transition plan, facilitate knowledge transfer, communicate departure to team, approve final timecard.
Human Resources (HR)	Confirm resignation, manage offboarding process, conduct exit interview, process final paperwork, provide benefits information (e.g., COBRA).
IT Department	Deactivate system and physical access, collect all IT assets.
Finance Department	Process final paycheck, manage final expense reports, ensure return of company credit cards.

10.0 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: What is the minimum notice I need to give?
A: For non-managerial roles, the minimum notice is two weeks. For managerial roles, it is four weeks, and for executives, it is six weeks.

Q2: Do I have to write a resignation letter?
A: Yes, a formal, written resignation letter is required to officially begin the separation process.

Q3: What should I do with my company laptop and phone?
A: All company property, including your laptop and phone, must be returned to the IT department on or before your last day.

Q4: Is the exit interview mandatory?
A: The exit interview is voluntary but highly encouraged. Your honest feedback is extremely valuable to us.

Q5: When will I receive my final paycheck?
A: Your final paycheck will be issued in accordance with applicable state and local laws, typically on your last day of employment or on the next scheduled payday.

Q6: Will I be paid for my unused vacation days?
A: Yes, any accrued, unused vacation or PTO will be paid out in your final paycheck, as required by law.

Q7: Can I take a vacation during my notice period?
A: Taking leave during your notice period is discouraged and requires manager approval.

Q8: How do I continue my health insurance?
A: You will receive information about continuing your health coverage through COBRA from our benefits administrator shortly after your last day.

Q9: What happens to my 401(k)?
A: You will receive information from our 401(k) provider about your options, which include rolling over your balance, leaving it in the plan (if eligible), or cashing it out.

Q10: Who can I give as a reference from the company?
A: Please direct all official requests for employment references to the HR department.

Q11: Can I change my mind after I have resigned?
A: Rescinding a resignation is not guaranteed and is subject to company approval based on business needs.

Q12: What if I don't return a piece of company property?
A: You may be held financially responsible for unreturned items, and the value may be deducted from your final pay, where permitted by law.

Q13: How will my departure be communicated to my team?
A: Your manager will work with you to determine the best way to announce your departure to the team and other stakeholders.

Q14: What is a "relieving letter"?
A: It is an official document from the company that confirms you have completed your employment and have been relieved of all duties in good standing.

Q15: Am I eligible to be rehired in the future?
A: If you leave in good standing and provide adequate notice, you are generally eligible for rehire.

Q16: Do I need to submit a final expense report?
A: Yes, all outstanding business expenses must be submitted for reimbursement before your last day.

Q_17: What happens to my company email account?
A: Your email account and all other systems access will be deactivated at the end of your last working day.

Q18: What if I have a grievance during my notice period?
A: The company's Grievance Procedure remains available to you throughout your notice period.

Q19: What is the difference between resignation and retirement?
A: Resignation is ending your employment to pursue other opportunities, while retirement is ending your career after meeting specific age and service requirements.

Q20: Where can I find the offboarding checklist?
A: HR will provide you with the offboarding checklist after your resignation is formally accepted.

11.0 Revision History

Version	Date of Revision	Summary of Changes	Approved By
1.0	Jan 1, 2024	Initial release of the comprehensive Exit and Resignation Procedure.	Chief Human Resources Officer

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